

9. For code blocks, the opening parenthesis should be at the end of the line, and the closing parenthesis should be the first character on a new line.

```
as_bare_character <- function(x) {
  if (is.character(x) && !is.object(x)) {
    # All OK!
    return(x)
  }
  ...
}
```

10. Ensure that code fits within 80 characters per line, as it is readable when printed.
11. Use one argument per line if a function call is very long. For example:

```
str_order <- function(x,
  decreasing = FALSE,
  na_last = TRUE,
  locale = "en",
  numeric = FALSE,
  ...) { }
```

12. Avoid using a semi-colon at the end of a line.
13. Always use '<-' for an assignment operation instead of '='.

```
> i <- 1
```

14. The preference is to use double quotes instead of single quotes for text.
15. Use TRUE and FALSE instead of T and F for readability.
16. A comment must always begin with the hash symbol followed by a space — '#'. Comments must not be written to explain *what* or *how* the code works. They must answer the question *why*.
17. The *return* keyword must only be used to return early from a function. Otherwise, the last evaluated expression result should be used to return from a function.
18. You can use *roxygen2* to provide inline documentation in comments along with your code.

```
#' Count the number of matches in a string
#'
#' Vectorised over `string` and `pattern`.
#'
#' @inheritParams str_detect
#' @return An integer vector.
#' @seealso
#' [stringi::stri_count()] which this function wraps.
#'
```

```
#' [str_locate()]/[str_locate_all()] to locate position
#' of matches
#'
#' @export
#' @examples
#' fruit <- c("apple", "banana", "pear", "pineapple")
#' str_count(fruit, "a")
#' str_count(fruit, "p")
#' str_count(fruit, "e")
#' str_count(fruit, c("a", "b", "p", "p"))
#'
#' str_count(c("a.", "...", ".a.a"), ".")
#' str_count(c("a.", "...", ".a.a"), fixed("."))
str_count <- function(string, pattern = "") {
  check_lengths(string, pattern)
```

```
  switch(type(pattern),
    empty = ,
    bound = stri_count_boundaries(string, opts_brkiter =
opts(pattern)),
    fixed = stri_count_fixed(string, pattern, opts_fixed =
opts(pattern)),
    coll = stri_count_coll(string, pattern, opts_collator
= opts(pattern)),
    regex = stri_count_regex(string, pattern, opts_regex =
opts(pattern))
  )
}
```

19. The *tests/* folder files should match the source files in the *R/* folder. For example, for *R/case.R* the corresponding test file should be *tests/testthat/test-case.R*.
20. The project sources should have a *NEWS* file containing the relevant changes to the sources. Also add a *LICENSE* file to ensure the licence under which the sources are released.

You are encouraged to read the references for more information on the R syntax. In the next article in this R series, we shall explore R data structures. **END** 

## References

- [1] Syntax: Operator Syntax and Precedence, <https://rdr.io/r/base/Syntax.html>
- [2] Tinyverse Style Guide, [https://style.tidyverse.org/\\_main.pdf](https://style.tidyverse.org/_main.pdf)
- [3] Style, <https://github.com/r-lib/style>
- [4] Linter, <https://github.com/jimhester/linter>
- [5] roxygen2, <https://roxygen2.r-lib.org/>

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